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Report of the Independent Expert Group on

Artificial Intelligence and Culture

2025

The present report was prepared by an Independent Expert Group convened by UNESCO to gather views and ideas on culture and artificial intelligence. In recognition of the central role of knowledge and ideas in transformation, this initiative reflects UNESCO's role as a laboratory of ideas. By generating novel insights, the document aims to contribute – among other sources – to the discussions at MONDIACULT 2025. Unless otherwise expressly stated, the findings, interpretations and conclusions contained herein are those of the independent experts who prepared the document and do not necessarily represent the views of UNESCO, its Member States, or any institution, nor do they commit the Organization in any way.

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Figure 1. The cultural value chain in the digital environment: from a 'pipeline' configuration to a network model	

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Participating in their personal capacity, each of the ten experts and two youth representatives brought unique insights, and it was through dialogue, exchange and collaboration that this document came to fruition.

The members of the Group were:

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Above all, the Group hopes that the reflections presented here will contribute to advancing cultural rights, diversity and sustainability in the age of artificial intelligence.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The **Independent Expert Group on Artificial Intelligence and Culture (CULTAI)**, convened by UNESCO, examined how AI is reshaping creativity, heritage and cultural ecosystems worldwide. The Group's analysis highlights an urgent reality: artificial intelligence is advancing faster than cultural governance, widening divides and raising new risks, while also offering powerful opportunities to reinforce cultural innovation and resilience.

AI is already transforming how culture is created, shared and preserved. It can expand access, safeguard heritage, amplify diverse voices and open new creative possibilities. At the same time, it can deepen inequalities, intensify biases, accelerate cultural homogenization and increase environmental costs.

The report identifies **core challenges**:

- **Outpacing of governance**, as the acceleration of AI exceeds the capacity of cultural ecosystems to adapt, threatening sovereignty, pluralism and democratic oversight;
- **Reinforcement of bias and homogenization**, as unbalanced training data and algorithmic personalization reproduce stereotypes and foster monocultures;
- **Undermining of cultural rights**, through the exploitation of unprotected cultural data without consent, attribution, or compensation and the marginalization of minority cultures; and
- **Erosion of creativity and skills**, as overreliance on AI weakens human creativity and cognitive capacities.

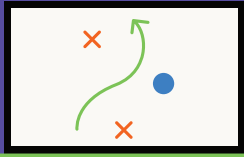
It also highlights **opportunities**, notably:

- **Expansion of creativity and access**, by lowering entry barriers and enabling new creative forms;
- **Protection of cultural heritage**, through restoration, conservation, post-disaster response and the preservation of endangered languages;
- **Strengthening of cultural and creative industries**, as automation of routine tasks reduces costs and enhances the competitiveness of small enterprises; and
- Advancement of equitable **learning opportunities**, with museums and cultural institutions cultivating AI literacy, creativity and critical reflection.

The Independent Expert Group calls for global cooperation and inclusive governance to ensure that AI strengthens cultural diversity, equity and sustainability. Rights-based approaches to AI, green practices, fair creative economies and sustainable cultural futures must place human creativity and cultural rights at the centre of technological development.

Culture and Artificial Intelligence

Challenges



Rapid technological
acceleration
in creative sectors



Unequal access
across regions



Rising ethical concerns
around rights and
ownership

Imperatives



Rights-based AI
governance:
transparency,
safeguards, fair
compensation



Fair & diverse creative
economies: algorithmic
diversity, public
infrastructure, skills
development



Sustainable & resilient
futures: low-impact AI,
heritage protection,
inclusion of local
knowledge